was a necessary condition for success. At this point, and to increase the chances of success, the agency heads agreed to divulge their respective sources and capabilities.

Latin America—that is, Central and South America, from Mexico and southward—was a great concern of mine, as I saw it as a major potential target for terrorist attacks in general, and for attacks on Jewish targets in particular. Unfortunately, I was right to be concerned. In 1992 the Israeli embassy in Buenos Aires was blown up by a car bomb, and two years later the city's Jewish community center, AMIA, was attacked. The two attacks were carried out by Hezbollah with Iranian assistance.

My concern over this region had its genesis back in 1988, when, as deputy director of the Mossad, I conducted a study tour of the continent. The general intelligence picture established in the late 1980s and early 1990s, both through regular monitoring and via specific intelligence activities, was not encouraging. Our first important insight from the study of the continent was that the Arab communities in South America were integrated in all aspects of life, society, and politics, unlike in the rest of the world, where the Arab communities generally centered almost exclusively on economics and business. Obviously, this is the full right of Arab citizens in these countries, but it had political, security, and intelligence implications for Israel. Demographically speaking, it is important to mention that the largest Palestinian community in the world outside of the Middle East is in Chile.

There is no lack of Arab politicians in South America, including the Argentinean president of Syrian descent Carlos Menem, during whose term in office the attacks on the embassy and the AMIA building were carried out. Rumor had it that during that period Arabic was the spoken language in the presidential palace. There are many governors, members of parliament, and ministers of Arab origin as well as Arab journalists and owners of newspapers and radio and television stations. Many citizens of Arab origin work in South America's security services.

The triborder area between Brazil, Argentina, and Paraguay, called Foz do Iguacu, is reminiscent of a typical large town in Lebanon. Arabic is the second most common language there, after Spanish. Traders of Lebanese origin dominate the huge local market. Five times a day, the muezzin calls out from the minarets of the town's many mosques, inviting the faithful to come to pray. Tens of thousands of people and cars pass freely between the three countries each day. In the 1980s and 1990s, Foz do Iguacu served as a